# Comparatives and superlatives

**Goal:** By the end of this lesson, you will be able to compare two landmarks with comparatives (taller than, more famous than) and to pick out one landmark from a group with superlatives (the tallest, the most famous).

**The idea in two lines:** Short adjectives take **-er / the -est** (old → older → the oldest); long adjectives take **more / the most** (beautiful → more beautiful → the most beautiful). A few adjectives are irregular: good, bad, far.

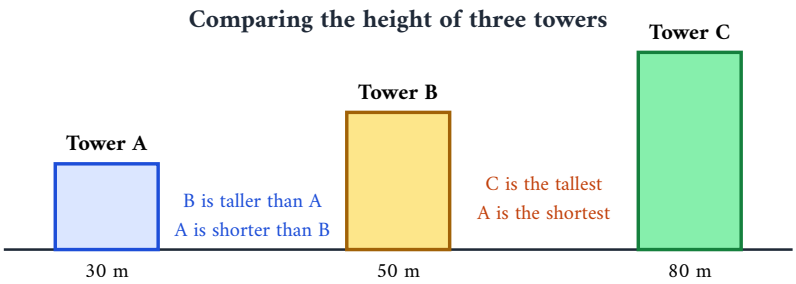



Figure 1: Comparative (two things) versus superlative (one thing out of a group).

## 🔵 Rules and concepts

1. The **comparative** compares two things and is followed by **than**: *The Eiffel Tower is taller than Big Ben.*
2. The **superlative** picks one thing out of three or more and is preceded by **the**: *Mount Everest is the highest mountain in the world.*
3. **One-syllable adjectives:** add -er / -est (*old → older → the oldest*). After one vowel + one consonant, double the consonant: *big → bigger → the biggest.*
4. **Two-syllable adjectives ending in -y:** change y to i: *busy → busier → the busiest, pretty → prettier → the prettiest.*
5. **Longer adjectives:** use *more / the most*: *famous → more famous → the most famous*; *interesting → more interesting → the most interesting.*
6. **Irregular forms:** *good → better → the best*; *bad → worse → the worst*; *far → farther / further → the farthest / the furthest.*

7. **Equality:** *as + adjective + as*: *The Casbah is as famous as the Medina of Tunis.* Negative: *not as … as*.

### 🟢 Examples

1. Complete: *The Great Wall of China is (long) … than Hadrian's Wall.* **Answer:** longer than. **Explanation:** *long* is a one-syllable adjective, so we add -er and keep *than*.
2. Complete: *Timgad is one of (impressive) … Roman sites in Algeria.* **Answer:** the most impressive. **Explanation:** *impressive* has three syllables; superlative = *the most* + adjective.
3. Complete: *The weather in the Sahara is (bad) … than in Algiers in summer.* **Answer:** worse than. **Explanation:** *bad* is irregular; never write "badder" or "more bad".

### 🟠 Common BEM mistakes

- Double comparison: "more taller", "the most biggest". Choose -er or more, never both.
- Forgetting **than** after a comparative: "Paris is bigger Oran" instead of *bigger than Oran*.
- Forgetting **the** before a superlative: "Everest is highest mountain" instead of *the highest mountain*.
- Spelling: "biger", "hotest". Double the final consonant: *bigger, hottest*.

### 🟡 Quick review

- Two things → comparative + than; three or more → the + superlative.
- Short adjective → -er / -est; long adjective → more / the most.
- -y → -ier / -iest; big → bigger / biggest.
- good / better / best; bad / worse / worst; far / farther / farthest.
- Same degree: as … as; not as … as.

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